

Latitude.

on belonging, displacement & return



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point of Point of *origin* *origin*

WHERE EVERYTHING BEGINS

Every story starts somewhere, and that somewhere never really leaves us. It lingers in memory, in the sound of our voice, or in the way we see light fall across a landscape. *Point of Origin* is that first mark on the map.

Where we come from isn't something that can be neatly marked on a map. Origins aren't fixed points. They are thresholds. To speak of origin is to speak of movement — the kind that happens between languages and silences, between feeling at home and feeling out of place, between holding on and letting go. Sometimes, origins are drawn in the dirt and water. Other times, they live in memory — in the circles we trace as we return, again and again, to places that feel both close and impossibly distant. But origins don't stay still. They shift with each move, each translation, and each act of starting over. When we leave, we don't break the connection. We allow it to stretch and grow into something new. In that way, a point of origin can hold two

truths: can be something to return to and something to move beyond. It can offer comfort, while also calling us to change, and it can hold steady, even as we remake ourselves around it.

This opening is meant to set the tone for what follows. It's a quiet invitation to begin here, somewhere between the ground beneath us and the horizon ahead.

As you turn these pages, think of them not as a guide with clear directions, but as a living map . One that shifts and reshapes with every story of roots, misfits, memory, and change. There are no hard borders here. Only lines that move, asking you to follow them, and to notice how identity often loops back to where it began.



sense of belonging
Sense of *belonging*



I PRAY THAT ONE DAY I CAN MEET MY HOME.
A PLACE IN WHICH I FEEL I TRULY BELONG.

NOT BECAUSE IT SPEAKS MY TONGUE.
NOT BECAUSE IT HEARD MY FIRST BREATH.
BUT BECAUSE IT KNOWS ME IN A WAY
I DO NOT EVEN KNOW MYSELF.

THAT PLACE WILL BEAR MY FRUITS.
& IT WILL HOLD MY FUTURE:

I WILL CALL IT HOME.
AND IT WILL CALL ME ITS OWN

made of Earth Made of Earth.

WHERE ROOTS TAKE HOLD

The earth keeps a record. It holds the shape of footsteps, the weight of harvest, the silence of mountains. To grow from soil is to inherit its memory: the smell of rain rising from dust, the grain of stone pressed into your palms. Even when distance stretches wide, fragments remain; quiet reminders that who we are is written first in the land beneath us.

To speak of the earth is to speak of memory. The soil holds more than we ever could: the pressure of bare feet, the rhythm of changing seasons, the weight of harvests gathered and then forgotten. Every field carries traces of the people who worked it. Stones bear the slow imprint of wind, water, and time. The ground does not forget, it holds its stories quietly, waiting for someone to listen. Even when we leave, pieces of that memory stay with us. The smell of rain falling on dry earth. The feel of rough stone beneath our hands. The silence of hills and mountains that seem to watch without speaking.

These moments come back to us when we least expect them. They remind us that who we are is shaped not only by family or language, but also by the land that raised us. A place leaves an imprint, just like a person does. The earth teaches us about change and permanence.



Crops grow and fade. Rivers carve new paths. Hills shift, slowly wearing down. And yet, something endures. Generations become part of the soil. What our grandparents planted lives on in ways we might not see. What we leave behind will become part of someone else's story. The land does

not demand attention, but it influences us just the same. Belonging is more than tradition or culture. It is also physical. We carry the shape and memory of the land with us, often without realizing it. When we are far from it, the difference becomes clear. The soil feels unfamiliar. Still, deep inside, something remembers.

NO MATTER HOW FAR
WE TRAVEL, THE EARTH
WE BEGAN ON STAYS
WITH US. LIKE A
FOUNDATION WE
NEVER STOPPED
STANDING ON.

HELLO, I AM THE MISFIT
I CANNOT TELL YOU WHAT
ELSE I AM BECAUSE THAT
IS (STILL) A MYSTERY TO
ME.

*maybe you can look
at me and tell me
what you see?*



The Misfit

WHEN BELONGING SLIPS AWAY

Being a misfit means living at the edge of belonging. You're close enough to see it, maybe even reach for it, but never quite all the way inside. Your accent shifts in ways you didn't plan. The customs feel slightly off, like clothes that don't quite fit. Even the smallest things—a look, a laugh, or a silence—remind you that you are both part of the scene and somehow outside of it. It's not always loud, this feeling. More often, it pulls quietly in the background, steady and persistent, until it becomes something you carry without thinking. There's a kind of loneliness in that space, but also a certain clarity. When you don't fit neatly, you start to notice the things other people might miss. You catch the pauses in conversations, the subtle social cues, and the unspoken rules that say who's in and who's not. And maybe that's the strange advantage: being on the outside teaches you how fragile belonging really is. It shows you that identity isn't fixed, but something you build, often piece by piece, from many places.



The road never really goes straight. It curves, loops back, and doubles over like it's chasing its own shadow. Each twist hums with the memory of a place already passed, familiar but not quite the same.

And every footstep? It's both a memory and a whisper of what's coming. What starts off as a single, fragile thread doesn't stay that way. It stretches, knots, frays, and weaves itself into something richer.

Something that carries fragments of all its former selves. Like the sea folding wave upon wave, the path isn't marked by clear conclusions but by quiet returns. Over and over, it finds its way home by getting lost.

There is no final shape, only unfolding. What seems like progress is often remembering. Sometimes we walk not to arrive, but to recall the rhythm of our own becoming.

And in that motion—in that repetition—we find not answers, but belonging.

Returning line.

Full circle.

CLOSURE AS CONTINUATION

To come full circle is to return, but not as the same person. We step back onto familiar ground with feet shaped by everything we've lived through — the distance, the breaks, and the moments of renewal gathered along the way. The soil of origin is still there, still holding its memory, but it no longer defines us in the same way it once did. What was once a clear starting point has become a thread, woven through every departure and every arrival. It connects the person we were with the person we are becoming, holding space for both change and continuity.

This magazine has followed that thread — from roots that ground us to places that unsettle, from the discomfort of not quite fitting in to the quiet clarity that misfitting can bring. Each chapter has added another line to the map of identity. But those lines aren't straight. They bend. They overlap. Sometimes they even double back. And in doing so, they remind us that belonging isn't a fixed destination. It's something that shifts and reshapes, a balance between what we carry with us and what we become along the way.

Coming full circle doesn't mean returning to where we began unchanged. It's not about closing a loop. It's about seeing the starting point with new eyes. Every misstep, every detour, every layer added along the journey has shifted the view. What once looked torn now feels whole. Not because the rupture disappeared, but because it became part of the story.



So if this is an ending, it's also a beginning. Circles hold both. They close something off, but they also keep it going. And we arrive, once again, at the question that opened all of this:

who are we, and where do we belong?

Only now, the question feels bigger. There's more room in it. More grace. Maybe it was never about finding a final answer. Maybe the point was to keep tracing the lines. And to notice how, somehow, they always bring us back to where something new begins.



once again, the map redraws itself